

Vincent Peiling Li

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Education

University of Cambridge MPhil in Linguistic and Language Science	October 2026 – June 2027 (Predicted)
University of Edinburgh B.Sc. Psychology	Edinburgh, United Kingdom
Grade: First Class Honours (74/100, 4.00/4.00 equivalent) Relevant Course: Dissertation (85/100); Data Analysis for Psychology in R I&II; Human Speech (80/100, top 1 in class); Psychology of Conversation; Linguistics IA & IIB (audit); Phonetic Analysis and Empirical Methods (audit); Discourse Analysis (audit); Speech Production and Perception (audit); Natural Language Processing for Psychologists (audit) Awards: Pitt Award for EDI and Social Justice (£ 200); Carnegie Trust Vocation Scholarship (£ 5,292); Edinburgh Award (<i>Leadership in Student Opportunities</i>); Saltire Award (<i>Psychology Programme Representative</i>)	
Cambridge University Cambridge Access to Mental Health and Psychology Programme	August – September 2023
Cambridge University Cambridge International Summer Programme	July – August 2022
University of Edinburgh International Foundation Programme	September 2021– July 2022
Additional Training (EdX & Coursera, with Certificates)	
- Fundamentals of Neuroscience, Part 1: The Electrical Properties of the Neuron HavardX - CS50's Introduction to Computer Science HarvardX	
	August 2023 October 2024 – 2025

Publications and Presentations

(Under Review) Li, V., Sturt, P. (2026) *Do Face Emojis Elicit Parafoveal-on-Foveal Effects During Sarcasm Comprehension? Evidence from Eye Tracking in Chinese.*

Li, V., Sturt, P. (2026, September) *Do Face Emojis Elicit Parafoveal-on-Foveal Effects During Sarcasm Comprehension? Evidence from Eye Tracking in Chinese.* Poster at *Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP)*, Saarbrücken, Germany

Li, V., Corley, M. (2026, September) *Does Capitalisation Facilitate Sarcasm Comprehension? Evidence from Self-paced Reading.* Poster at *Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP)*, Saarbrücken, Germany

Li, V., Corley, M. (2026, May) *Are you being SARCASTIC? Capitalisation Effects on Sarcasm Comprehension in Online Text Communication.* Talk presented at *British Psychological Society Undergraduate Conference*, Glasgow, UK

Li, V. (2025, November) *Motivation vs Personality: What Drives Belonging for International Students?* Talk presented at *The EAP Student: Identity, Community, and Belonging Conference*, Edinburgh, UK

Li, V., (2025, May). Social Media's Double-Edged Sword on Imposter Syndrome: Platforms as Both Triggers and Tools for Resilience. *Edinburgh University Psychology Magazine*

Li, V. (2023, May). *Real-life Café vs. Virtual Café Noise Effects on Creative Work Performance.* Poster presented at *Edinburgh Scientific Research Association Annual Conference*, Edinburgh, UK.

Research Experience

University of Edinburgh	Edinburgh, United Kingdom
Undergraduate Dissertation Project (Grade: 85), supervised by Prof. Martin Corley	September 2025 – Present
Project: <i>How capitalisation affects sarcasm comprehension in online communication</i>	
- Independent dissertation on whether capitalisation (e.g., That is GREAT) helps sarcasm comprehension using online self-paced reading. - Designed and implemented the experiment using PCIBex (JavaScript), collected 113 participants; analysis suggests capitalisation functions as a pragmatic salience marker rather than a sarcasm-specific cue; journal manuscript in preparation. - This project is presented on <i>BPS Scotland Undergraduate Conference 2026</i> at the University of Strathclyde Glasgow and will be presented at <i>Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP) 2026</i> at Saarland University	
Summer Research Project (<i>Carnegie Trust Vocation Scholarship</i> , £ 5,292), supervised by Dr. Patrick Sturt	June 2025 – Present
Project: <i>Parafoveal-on-Foveal Effects of Emojis in Sarcasm Comprehension During Chinese Text Reading</i>	
- Pre-registered study on parafoveal processing and semantic incongruity effects of face emojis on sarcasm comprehension in Chinese text communication. - Independently designed and programmed the eye-tracking experiment using EyeLink 1000 and Experiment Builder, collected 66 Chinese adults, analysed eye-tracking data, and manuscript in preparation.	

- Results suggests that emoji–word semantic congruency influences late re-reading but not initial processing, showing a different pattern from previously reported effects of object emojis.
- This project will be presented at Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP) 2026 at Saarland University, and Currently under review for journal publication.

Independent Project, supervised by Dr. Faith Dillon-Lee

May – November 2025

Project: ***Motivation vs Personality: What Drives Belonging for International Students?***

- Investigating how motivation to engage is affected by personality (like extraversion) and affect their belongingness, using Qualtrics survey and mixed methods (thematic analysis and mediation analysis).
- Independently designed the study, created stimuli, built the experiment, analysed data, wrote the abstract and presented.
- Results show extraversion significantly affects belongingness, instead of motivation. The project is presented at *The EAP Student: Identity, Community, and Belonging Conference*.

Independent Projects, supervised by Prof. Martin Corley

Project: ***How conversation condition affects language prediction***

March 2025 – Present

- Investigating whether an explicitly communicative context shifts expectations from typicality-driven to informativity-driven predictions, predicting fewer looks to the stereotypical object.
- Created stimuli, built the experiment using EyeLink 1000 and OpenSesame, currently collecting data.

Project: ***How Direct/Indirect narratives affects comprehension of written sarcasm***

October 2024 – Present

- Pre-registered study on whether sarcasm is easier to understand direct quotations (he said "this is great") than indirect quotations ("he said that it was great") using a self-paced reading paradigm.
- Designed and implemented an online experiment using PCIBex (JavaScript), created stimuli, prepared materials, analysed data, with write-up in plan.
- Initial results suggest readers comprehend sarcasm faster in direct quotations, though the effect is not statistically significant.

Research Assistant to HollyMartin lab

July 2024 – October 2024

Project: ***Predicting language under difficult conditions: Effects of cognitive load, noise, and hearing impairment***

- Supported the ESRC-funded project with University of Nottingham investigating prediction in language comprehension under adverse conditions and was supervised by Prof. Martin Pickering and Dr. Naomi Nota.
- Recruited participants at Edinburgh site and conducted in-person eye-tracking experiment; collected, organised and managed participant data for multi-site collaboration.
- Contribution is acknowledged in the preprint at doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/qphfc_v1.

Independent Project (*Edinburgh Scientific Research Association*, £ 100), supervised by Dr. Chris Egan October 2022 – May 2023

Project: ***Real-life café vs. virtual café noise effects on creative work performance***

- Investigated whether the creative work performance is affected by staying at actual café or listening to virtual white noises.
- Independently designed the study, collected 30 participants via Qualtrics, used the Remote Associate Test to measure creative work performance, conducted analysis, presented at *Edinburgh Scientific Research Association Annual Conference*.
- Results suggested that participants who worked in an actual coffee shop or library achieved significantly higher scores on creative work performance, compared to participants who listened to virtual coffee shop or library white noises.

Shaanxi Normal University

Xi'an, China

Research Assistant to Dr. Yadan Li and Prof. Yilong Yang, Key Laboratory of Modern Teaching Technology of Ministry of Education

Project: ***Cognitive and neural mechanisms of creativity in bilinguals***

April 2021 – July 2021

- Contacted and scheduled participants for in-person testing, trained new undergraduate research assistants with experimental procedures, led the RAs to carry out the experiment, and designed certificates of attendance for the project.

Research Skills

Programming & Statistics

- **Programming:** R (Proficient), Python, JavaScript.
- **Statistical modelling:** Univariate and Multivariate analyses, linear mixed-effects models

Experimental & Analytical Tools

- **Experiment Design:** MATLAB, Psychtoolbox, E-Prime, PCIBex, Qualtrics, Prolific, Testable
- **Eye-tracking:** EyeLink 1000 (SR Research), Experiment Builder
- **Analysis & Discourse Coding:** RStudio, SPSS, Praat, ELAN, NVivo

Academic and Professional Engagement

Student Ambassador of BALEAP (The British Association of Lecturers in English for Academic Purposes)	November 2024
British Psychological Society Student Ambassador	August 2024 – May 2026
Volunteer Organiser of AMLaP 2024 (Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing)	September 2024
Volunteer Journal Writer of Edinburgh University Psychology Magazine (EUPM)	November 2024 – May 2025
Undergraduate Psychology Programme Representative (Years 2 – 4)	September 2023 – May 2026
Student Advisor & Co-manager of Curriculum Transformation	September 2023 – May 2024
Media Content Writer & Manager at Chinese Psychology Students Association, Edinburgh	November 2021 – May 2025